

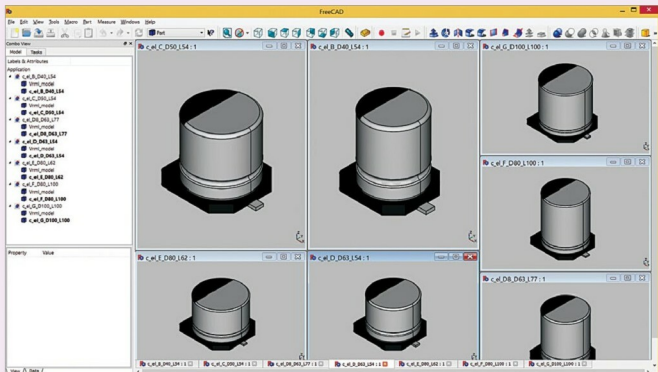


Fig. 3: Aluminium capacitor and its mechanical view (image courtesy: raw.githubusercontent.com)

even faster and more stable than the previous version (Fig. 2).

Touchscreen 3D navigation.

This makes it easy to navigate. The designer can move the design in any direction with a single finger drag. So FreeCAD can be used without a mouse on a convertible laptop with touchscreen and pen, away from a desk.

New tools to reduce work stress.

Mechanical parts can have a regular or a discrete shape. Older versions of FreeCAD software did not take various shapes into consideration, making it a constraint for designers to work freely on any dimension.

New tools for connect, embed and cutout have been introduced in the latest version. Tools for shapes such as round, trunc, ceil and floor have also been included; version 0.15 featured shapes like parabola and hyperbola. Besides, new features have been introduced for toggle mode, continuous creation mode, speed up, duplication and mirroring (Fig. 3). Rectangles, wires and lines can now be subdivided, allowing all kinds of new shape combinations.

A new spreadsheet view tool allows users to place a range of cells from a spreadsheet on a Drawing page (Fig. 4).

Edit in real time. You can see the 3D view in real time. This helps you visualise the actual dimension values of a shape. The new Finite Element Method (FEM) workbench allows cleanups, while Path workbench adds editing and import. So you can change the values in real time too. Edits made are saved immediately, helping you to conceptualise in a better way.

FEM workbench GUI

FreeCAD workbench consists of pre-processing, solving and post-processing.

Initially, geometry is modelled,

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